Loyalty, and the whole thing was pretty obviously casual, though I did notice as I left on the Friday morning that she was a little strange. Later that day, I got a call from Donald Böstrom, telling me he'd just spoken to A——, who had just spoken to W——, who told her she was in hospital. I must say I was completely baffled. These girls were talking to each other and one of them was in the hospital? My phones were hopeless, but on one of them I got another call from Donald, quoting A—— again, who was saying something about W—— and the police and DNA testing. I said, 'What on earth is going on?' So I called W—— and she totally denied these things, saying she had only mentioned police in relation to perhaps asking them for advice about tests you could get for sexually transmitted diseases.

W—— said she wanted me to come down immediately and have an STD test. I said I couldn't that day, I was dealing with heavy stuff, but I'd come the next day, and she said that was fine. She then asked me if I'd called her off my own bat, or because I'd been speaking to A——? It just became too ludicrous at this point. Donald was ringing me again and again, saying that A—— was trying to look out for me with this W—— situation, and I was saying, 'No, it's fine, I've spoken to W—— and we're meeting tomorrow.' The whole thing was zany, if anything, and deeply suspicious as the hours passed and the gossip flew. I spoke to A—— and asked her what was all this nonsense about police. She told me I didn't understand how it was in Sweden: you could just ask police for advice like that, about STDs and such like, and there's nothing in it and no formal complaint. Perhaps I should have been more suspicious about what was going on at this point, but, of course, I knew I had done nothing wrong and it therefore didn't occur to me what might happen next with the police.

I wanted to double-check things with W——, so I topped up one of my phones and called her several times that afternoon, with no reply. I needed some time and space to myself, so I then booked into a hotel for the night where I began writing what was to be the first of my Swedish newspaper columns. I had just written that line about the first casualty of war being truth when, about 6.30 p.m., I checked on Twitter and saw there was an arrest warrant out for me for double rape. At first, I thought this must be some tabloid garbage. Completely made up. I just thought, how low can they go, these papers? How far are they willing to go to smear a person? Then I saw, on the website of a more serious newspaper, that the arrest rumour was correct, and my entire belief system temporarily collapsed.